

MODDABLE CHESS · VARIANT 53 OF 153

# Einstein Chess

**8×8**

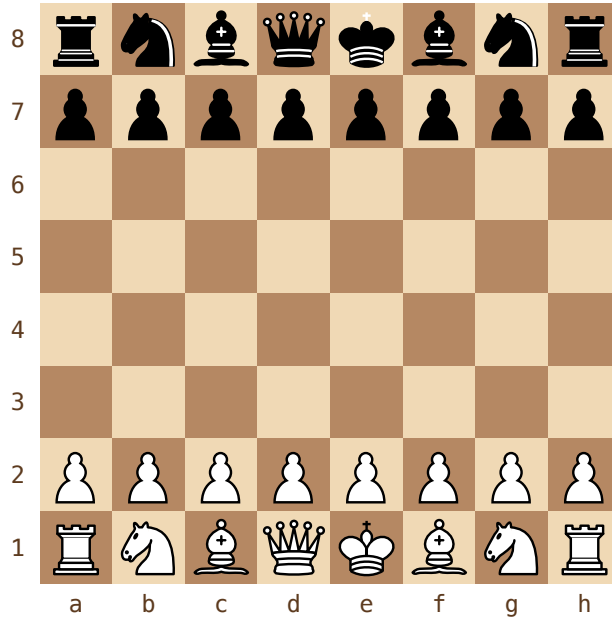
BOARD

**2**

PLAYERS

# EINSTEIN CHESS

Pieces transform after every move. Captures promote, non-captures demote – cycling through the piece hierarchy.



*Einstein Chess – starting position*

## SETUP

**Board:** Standard 8×8.

**Setup:** Standard chess setup.

**FEN:** rnbqkbnr/pppppppp/8/8/8/8/PPPPPPPP/RNBQKBNR w KQkq - 0 1

## RULES

- ♦ After a piece makes a non-capturing move, it demotes one step:  $Q \rightarrow R \rightarrow B \rightarrow N \rightarrow P$ .
- ♦ After a piece makes a capture, it promotes one step:  $P \rightarrow N \rightarrow B \rightarrow R \rightarrow Q$ .
- ♦ Kings are exempt – they never transform.
- ♦ Pawns that demote have nowhere to go (they remain pawns).
- ♦ Queens that promote have nowhere to go (they remain queens).
- ♦ Transformation happens immediately after the move resolves.
- ♦ Standard promotion on the 8th rank still applies to pawns.

#### **WIN CONDITION**

Checkmate the opponent's King.

#### **STRATEGY**

Every move changes your piece composition. Aggressive play (captures) builds stronger pieces, but quiet manoeuvring weakens them. Knights and Bishops are unstable — one capture turns them into Rooks, but one quiet move turns them into Pawns. Queens are fragile: one quiet move demotes to Rook. Material calculation is inverted.

#### **ATTRIBUTION**

Invented by B. Iqbal, 2005. Public domain.